

Problem #3: Translating Welsh (15 marks)

Solution:

The word order of Welsh sentences is *Subject Verb Object*

1. Verbs:
 - a. present or past verb = *yn* + verb;
 - b. has + verb = *wedi* + verb
 - c. past + going to + verb = *Roedd ... mynd i* + verb
 - d. present + going to + verb = *mynd i* + verb
 - e. will be + verb = *Bydd ... yn cael eu* + verb
2. *Mae'r* = The (at the beginning of a sentence), otherwise *y* = the
3. Nouns: *dyn* = man, *dynion* = men, *ci* = dog, *cŵn* = dogs, *morgrugyn* = ant, *morgrug* = ants
4. Verbs: *afnon* = send, *neidio* = jump, *llaad* = kill
5. Other words: *ar* = on
6. Welsh features a phenomenon called *soft mutation* where the initial consonant can become voiced under certain contexts. For example, *i* + *llaad* → *i laad*; *i* + *cael* → *i gael*

Assignment 1:

- a) The ants have killed the man = *Mae'r morgrug wedi lladd y dyn.*
- b) The dog jumps on the men. = *Mae'r ci yn neidio ar y dynion.*
- c) The men were going to jump on the ants. = *Roedd Mae'r dynion yn mynd i neidio ar y morgrug.*

Assignment 2:

- a) *Mae'r ci yn lladd.* = The dog kills **or** The dog killed.
- b) *Mae'r dyn yn anfon SMS.* = The man sent SMS **or** The man sends SMS.
- c) *Mae'r cŵn yn mynd i gael ei anfon.* = The dogs are going to be sent.

It is not possible to deduce the meanings of *gael* and *cŵn* from the given data. But based on the usage *mynd i gael ei* and similarity in spelling, one can guess that *gael* is actually same as *cael*. Similarly, the meaning of *cŵn* cannot be guessed, but based on the usage in the sentence, it is clear that the word is a noun. It actually means "dogs".
